

FRETBOARD INTERVALS CHORDS CONSTRUCTION



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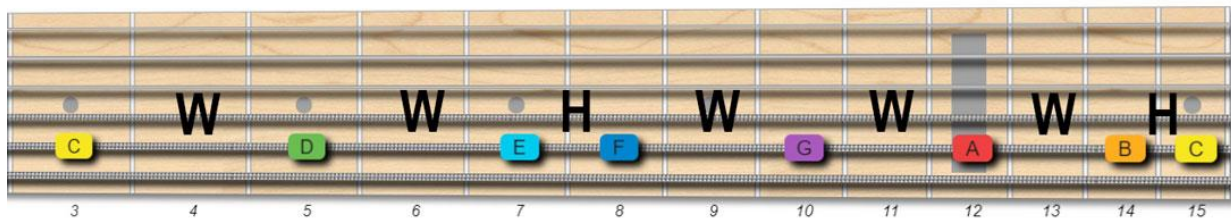
band@fachords.com

Gianca, founder of FaChords Guitar

Introduction

This ebook is a free complement of the in-depth tutorial on chords construction and fretboard intervals. Be sure to read the tutorial before using this ebook, at the following link:

<https://www.fachords.com/go/learn-chord-construction/>



Intervals

Here below you find a first table with the name of the intervals in the Major Scale; in the second table, you can see the remaining types of interval, obtained by raising or lowering one of the major scale intervals.

Note	Interval	Semitones
C	Root	0
D	Major Second	2
E	Major Third	4
F	Perfect Fourth	5
G	Perfect Fifth	7
A	Major Sixth	9
B	Major Seventh	11
C	Octave	12

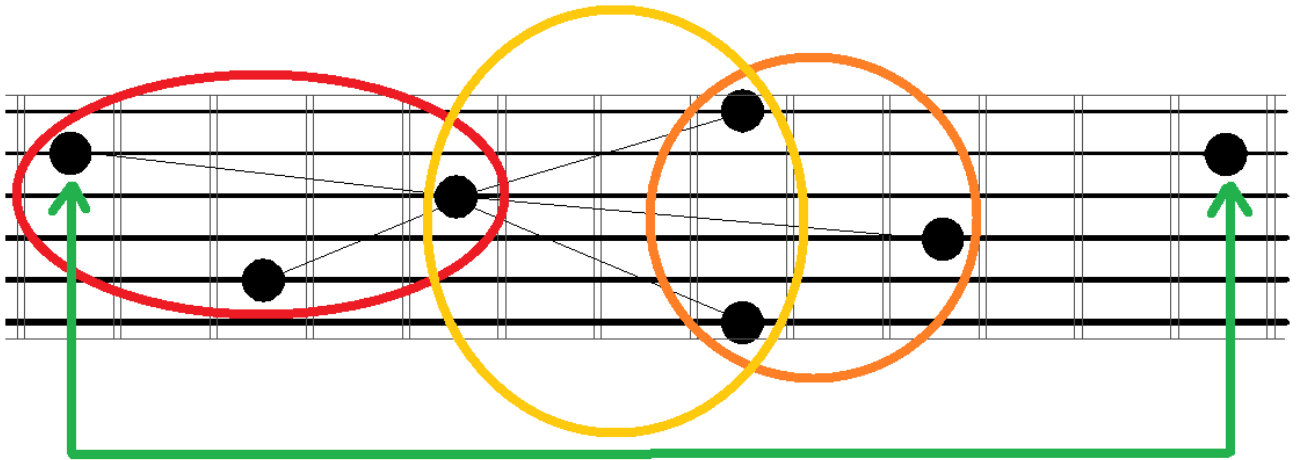
Flat Interval (1 hs down)	Interval	Sharp Interval (1 hs up)
Minor Second (1 hs)	Major Second (2 hs)	Augmented Second (3 hs)
Minor Third (3 hs)	Major Third (4 hs)	Augmented Third (5 hs)
Diminished Fourth (4 hs)	Perfect Fourth (5 hs)	Augmented Fourth (6 hs)
Diminished Fifth (6 hs)	Perfect Fifth (7 hs)	Augmented Fifth (8 hs)
Minor Sixth (8 hs)	Major Sixth (9 hs)	Augmented Sixth (10 hs)
Minor Seventh (10 hs)	Major Seventh (11 hs)	Augmented Seventh (12 hs)
	Octave (12 hs)	

Fretboard octaves

The first interval that you should memorize is the octave. Knowing your octaves is a great shortcut for fretboard navigation.

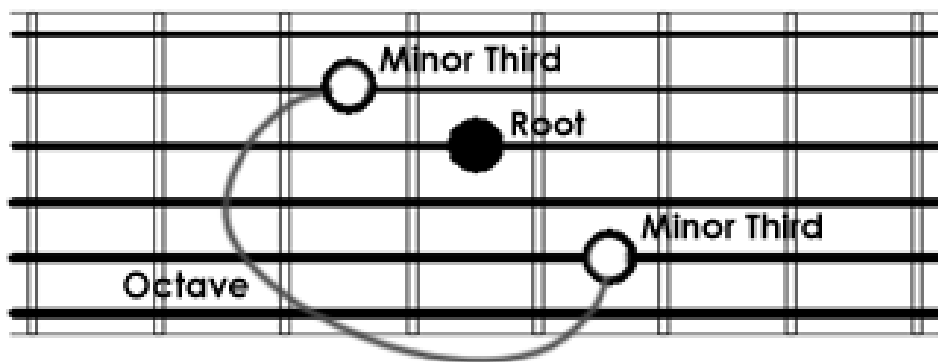
As you probably already know, two notes, spanning a distance of one octave, or 12 semitones, will have the same name (C and C), but different pitches.

Let's have a look at the picture below:



In the diagram above, black dots represent the same note (suppose a C).

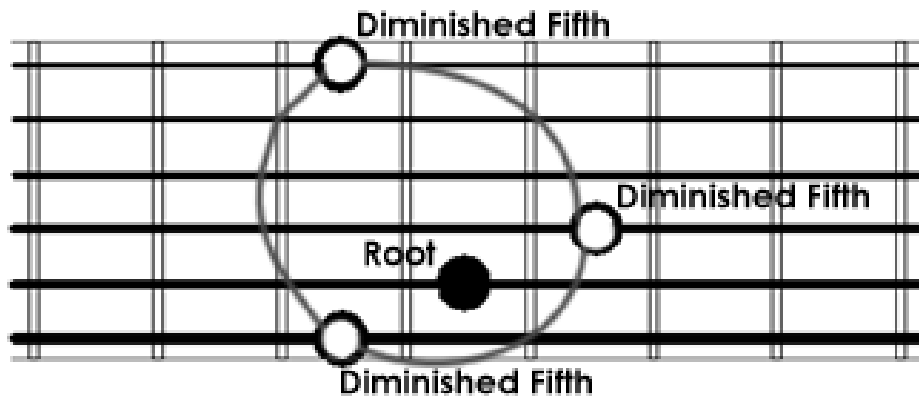
Using octave concepts, you can play the same tone on different strings. For example, in the minor third interval:



The root note is the one marked with the black dot (3rd string). You can play a minor third on the upper string (2nd string), but, using the octave trick, you may also play it on the second string.

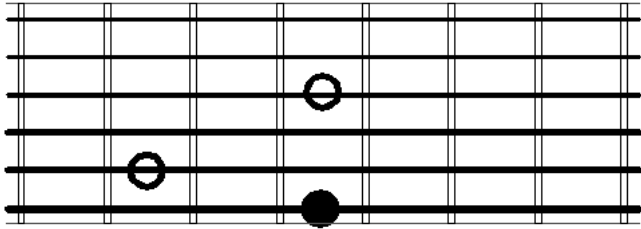
Another example, diminished fifth. In the next diagram, you see the different frets on which you can play a diminished fifth,

with respect of a root on the 5th string.



Now we're going to show you how to play a set of different intervals, with the root on each of the six strings. These intervals will be the building blocks for creating simple chords.

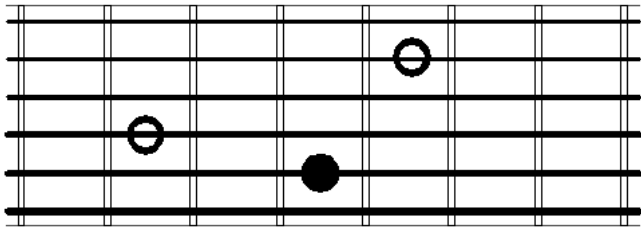
Graphic convention: in the following diagrams, the root note is marked with a black dot. Other notes are represented by an empty circle.



Minor Third

3 half-steps

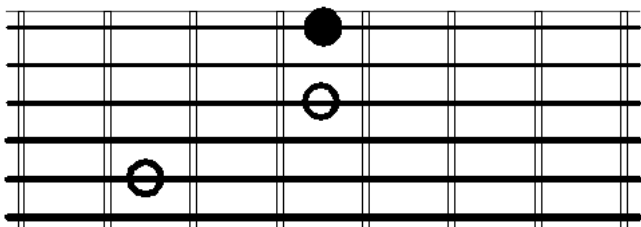
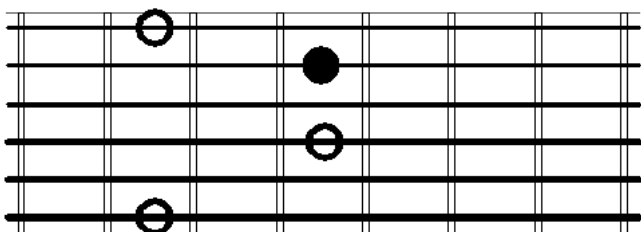
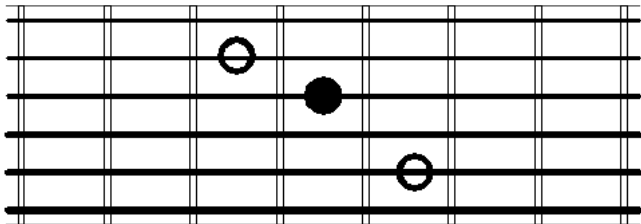
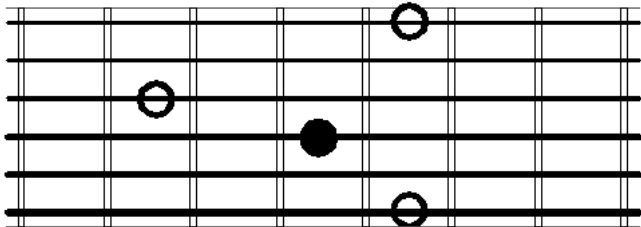
Adding 1 octave:

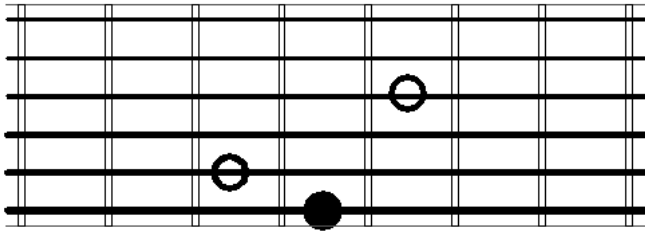


Minor Tenth

Enharmonic equivalent:

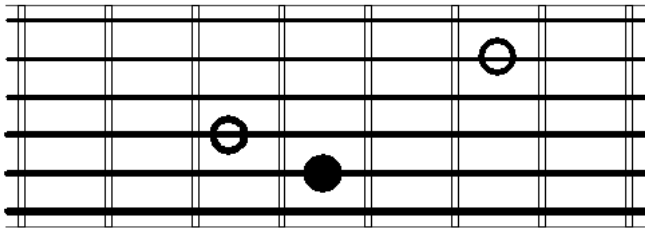
Augmented Second





Major Third

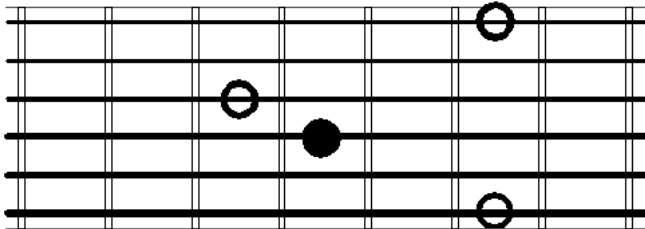
4 half-steps



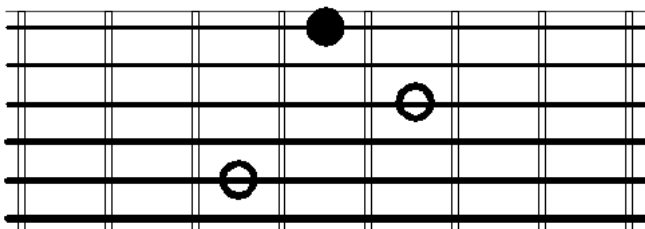
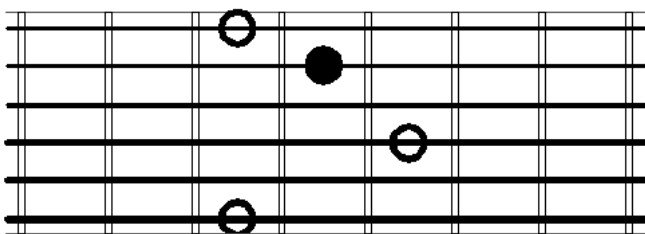
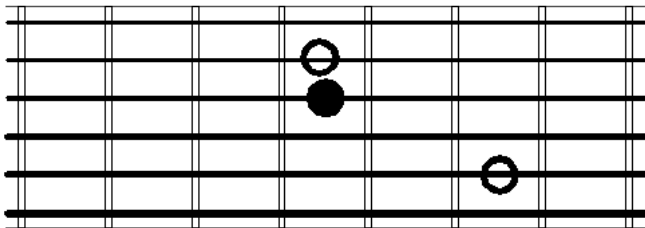
Adding 1 octave:

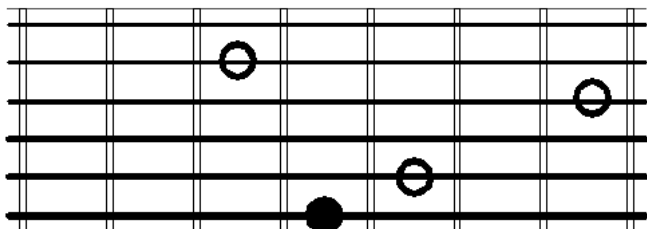
Major Tenth

Enharmonic equivalent:



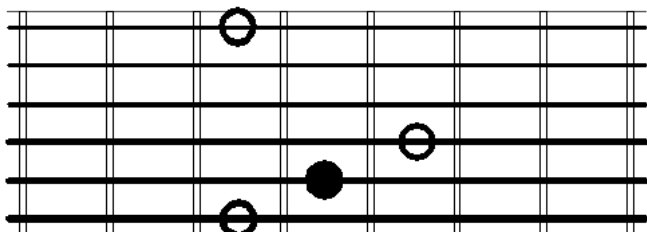
Diminished Fourth





Diminished Fifth

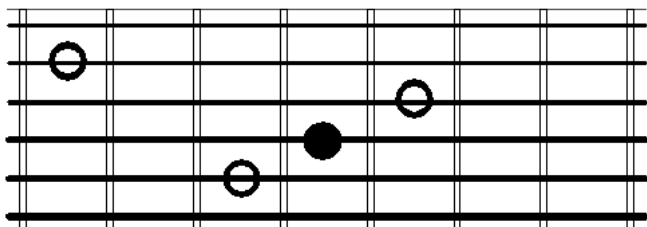
6 half-steps



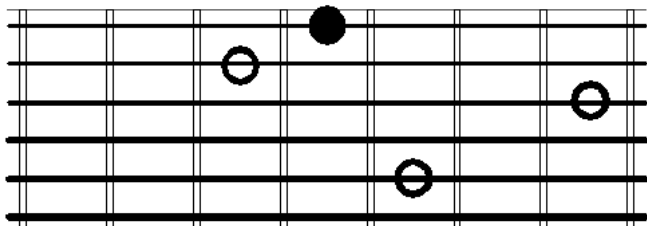
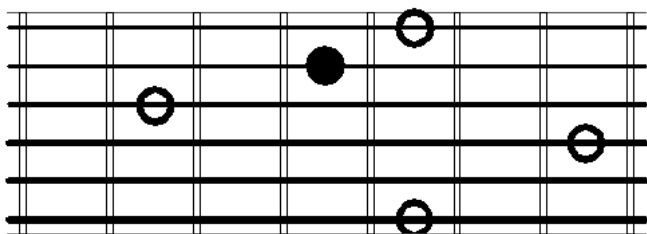
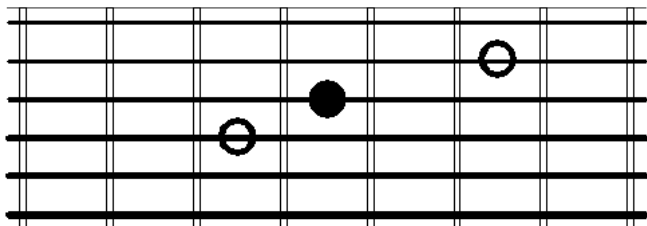
Adding 1 octave:

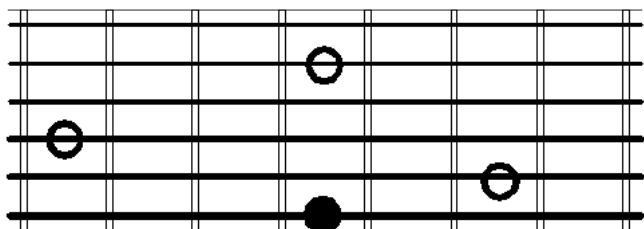
Diminished Twelfth

Enharmonic equivalent:



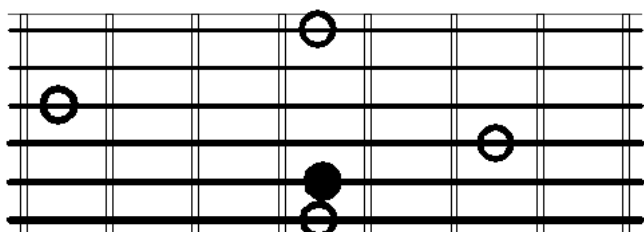
Augmented Fourth





Perfect Fifth

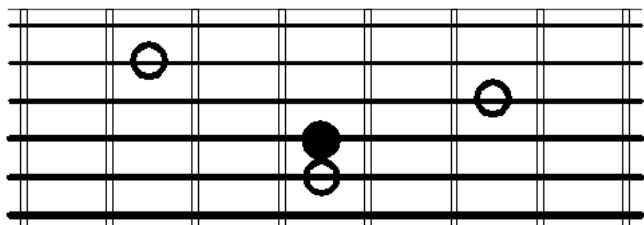
7 half-steps



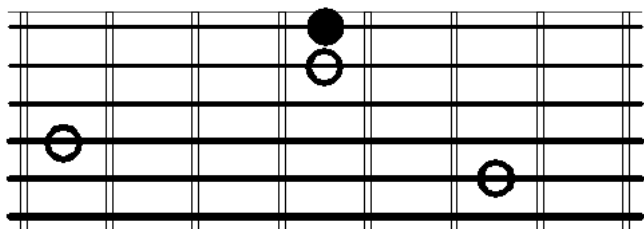
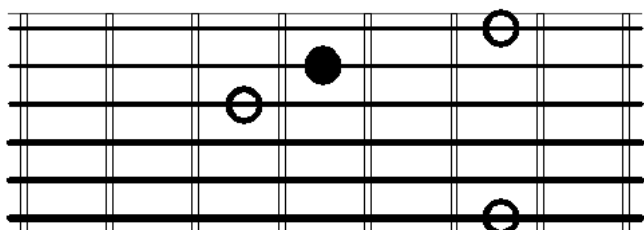
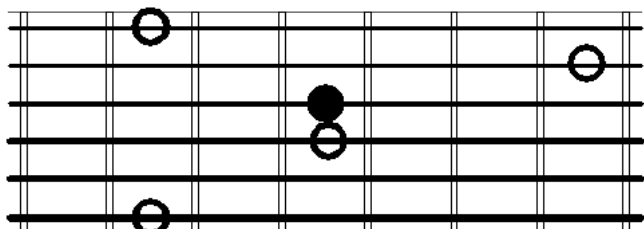
Adding 1 octave:

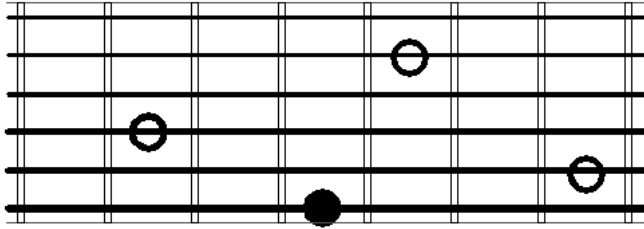
Perfect Twelfth

Enharmonic equivalent:



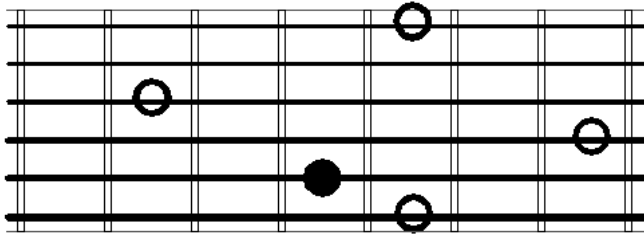
Diminished Sixth





Minor Sixth

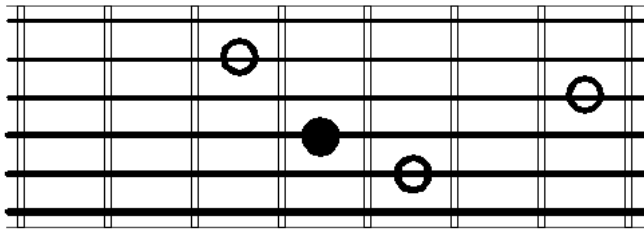
8 half-steps



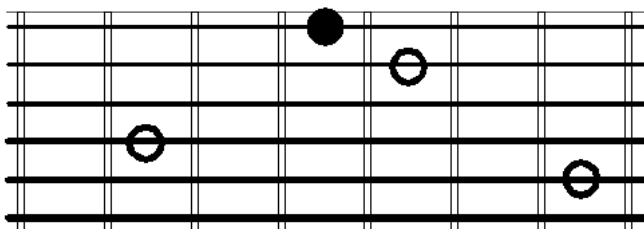
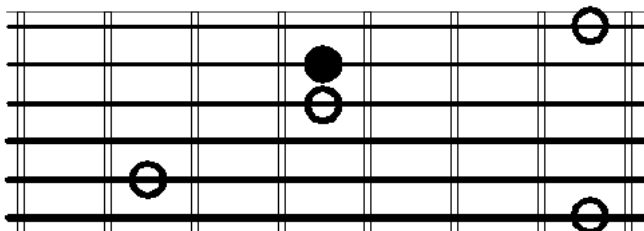
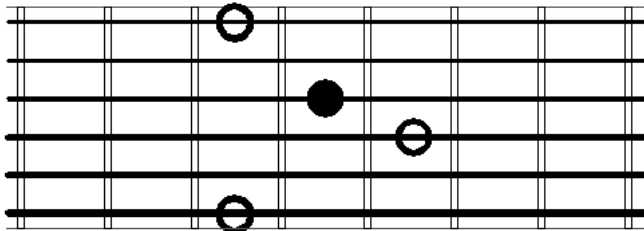
adding 1 octave:

Minor Thirteenth

Enharmonic equivalent:



Augmented Fifth



Chords construction

Now we're going to see some examples of chord constructions, using the intervals you've just learned (minor and major thirds, perfect fifth, diminished and augmented fifth).

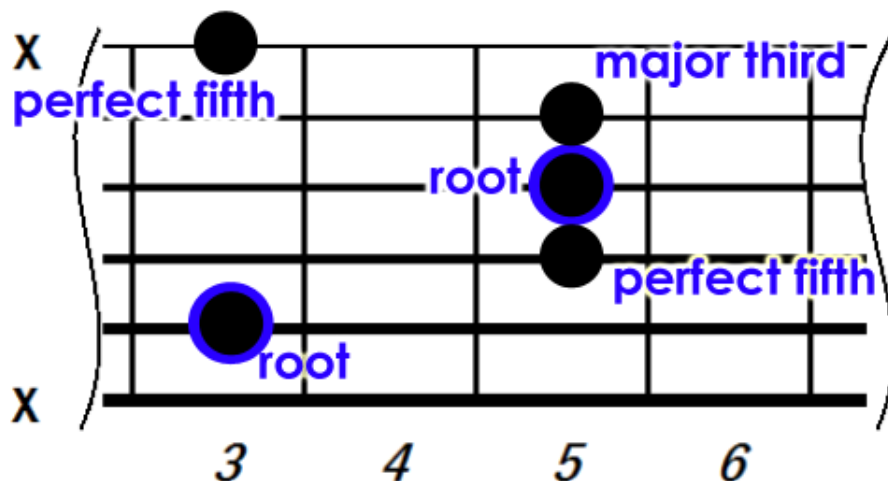
Try to recognize visually the intervals geometries you've seen on the previous diagrams. Due to the nature of the fretboard, in which a note is located on different strings, for a given chord can exist different fingerings and positions.

The following diagrams show just one of many possible fingerings..

Cmaj chord

Name variations: **C major**, **CM**, **C**

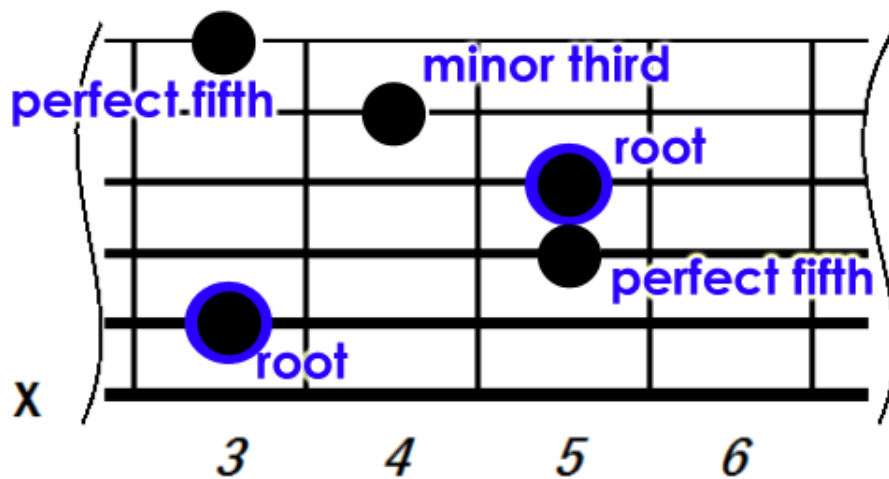
This chord is a major triad: root, major third, perfect fifth.



Cm chord

Name variations: **C minor**, **Cm**, **C-**

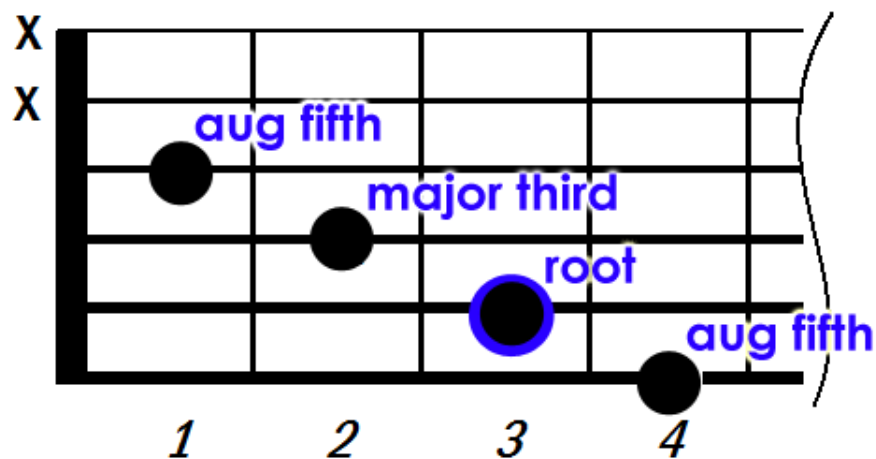
This chord is a minor triad: root, minor third, perfect fifth.



Caug chord

Name variations: **C augmented**

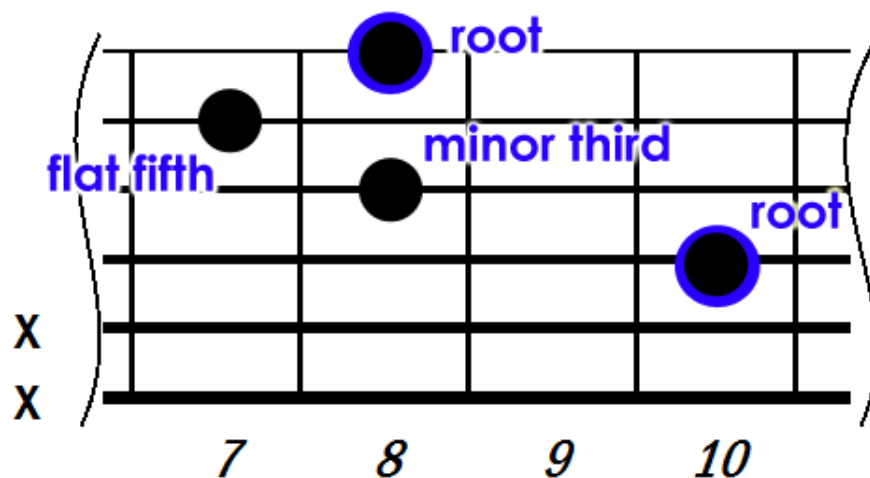
This chord is an augmented triad (root, major third, augmented fifth)



C-5 chord

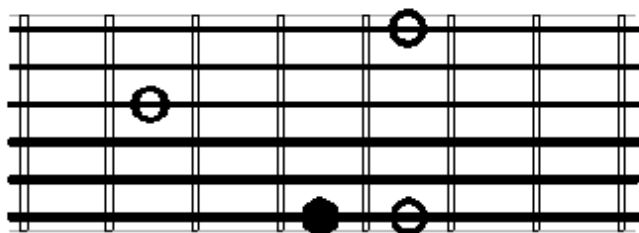
Name variations: **C diminished triad, Cb5**

This chord is composed of the root, a minor third and a flat fifth.



More Intervals

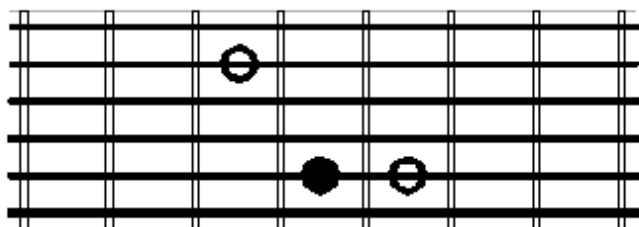
We can now move on and see the remaining types of interval: minor second, major second, perfect fourth, minor and major seventh, minor and major sixth.



Minor Second

1 half-step

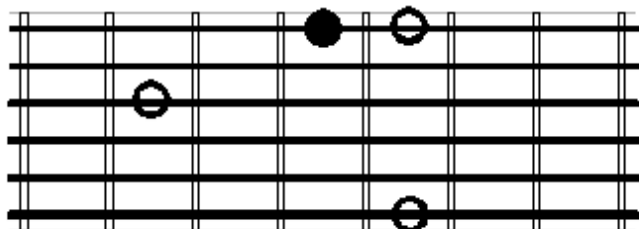
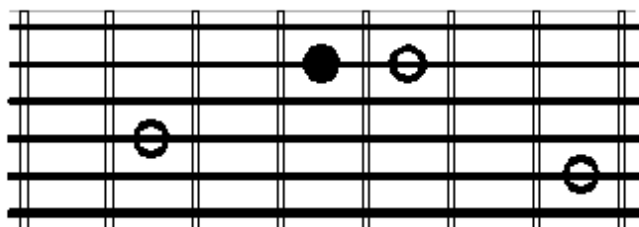
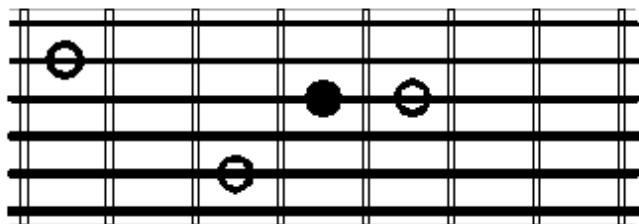
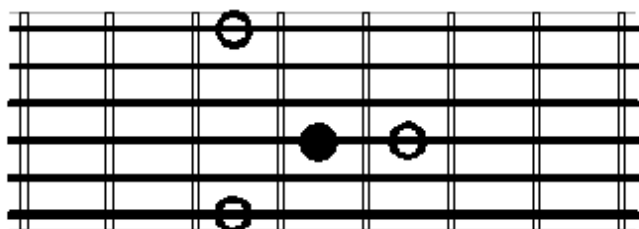
adding 1 octave:

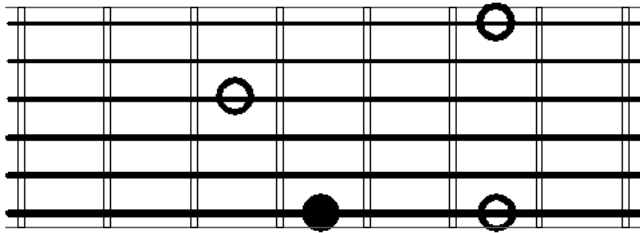


Minor Ninth

Enharmonic equivalent:

Augmented Unison

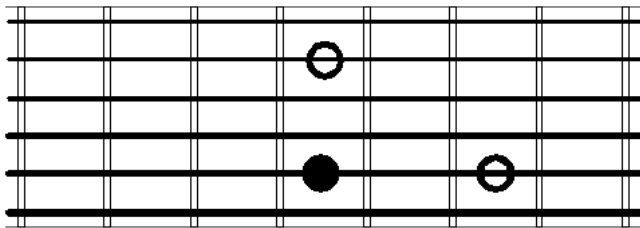




Major Second

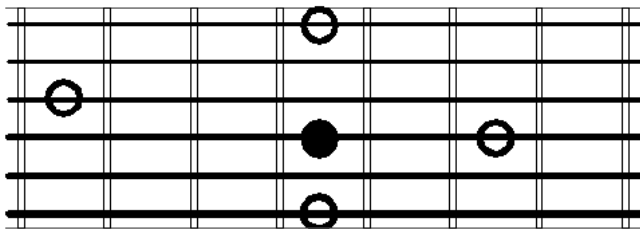
2 half-steps

Adding 1 octave:

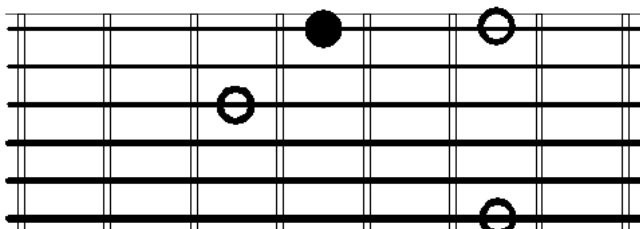
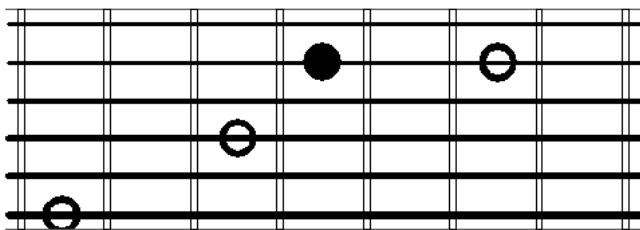
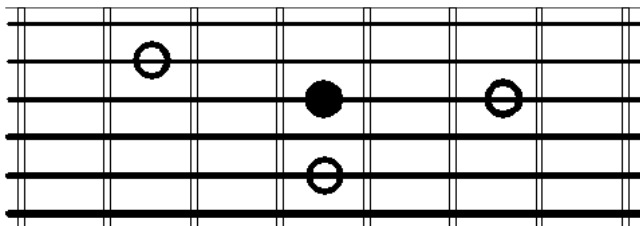


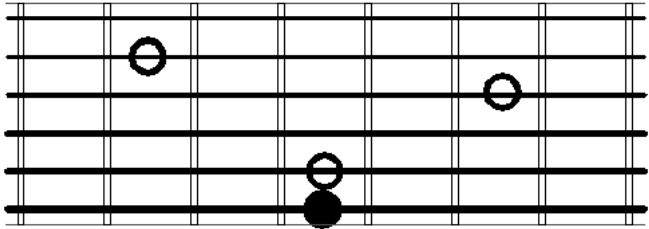
Major Ninth

Enharmonic equivalent:



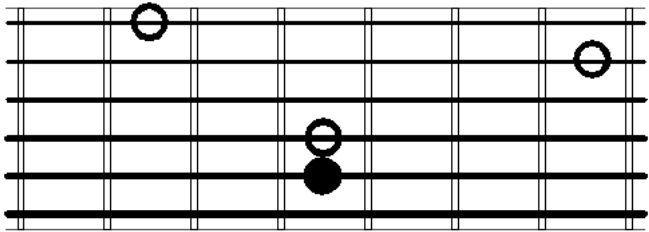
Diminished Third





Perfect Fourth

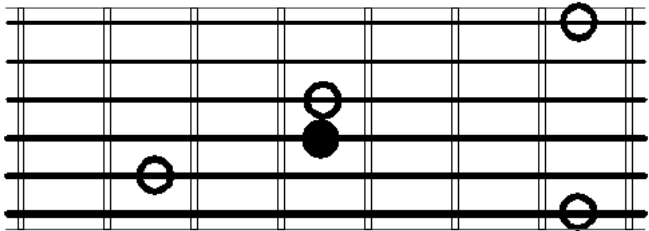
5 half-steps



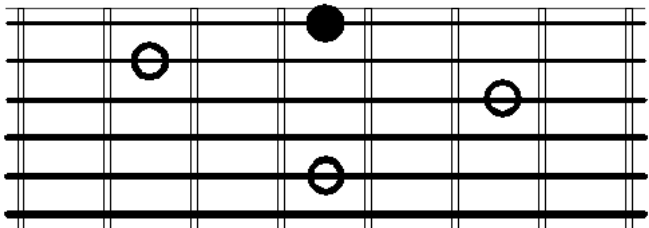
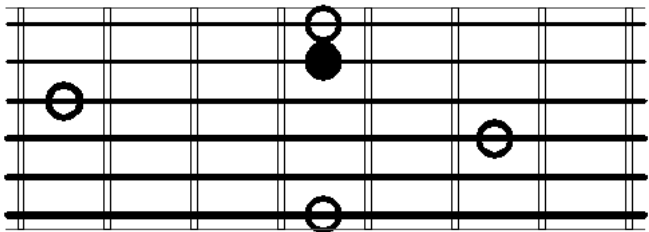
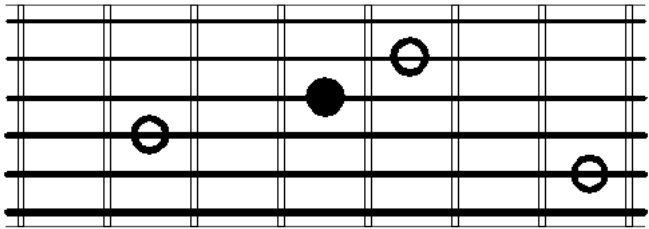
Adding 1 octave:

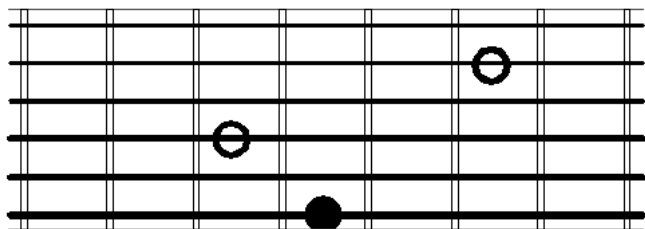
Perfect Eleventh

Enharmonic equivalent:



Augmented Third

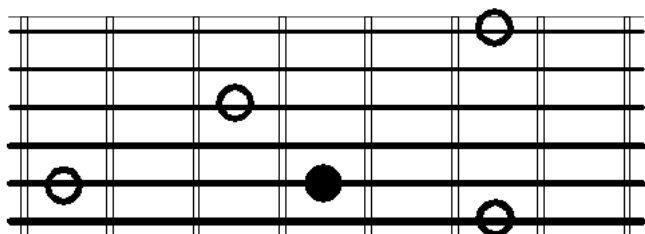




Major Sixth

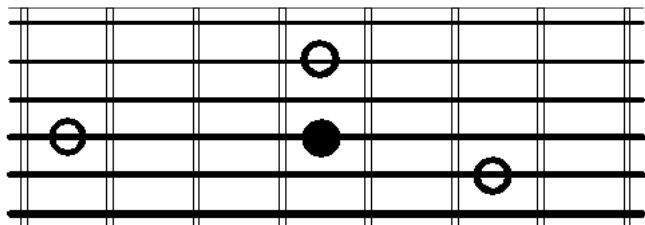
9 half-steps

adding 1 octave:

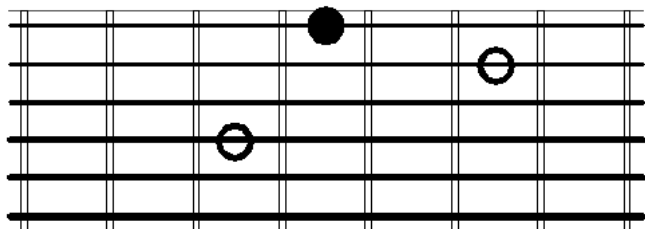
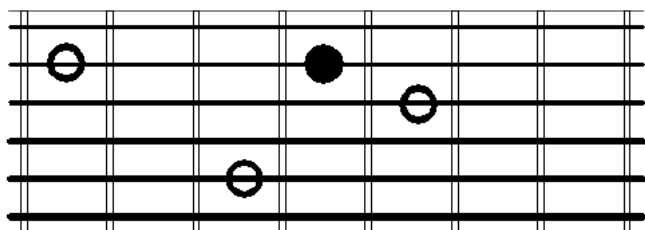
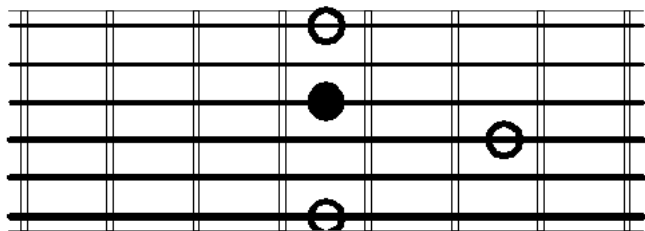


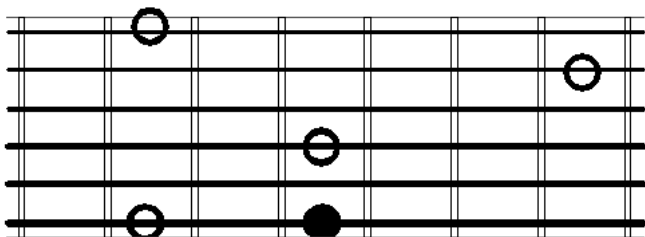
Major Thirteenth

Enharmonic equivalent:



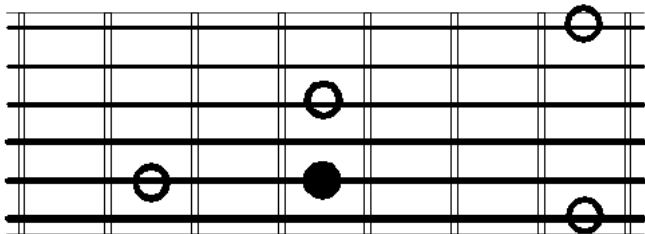
Diminished Seventh





Minor Seventh

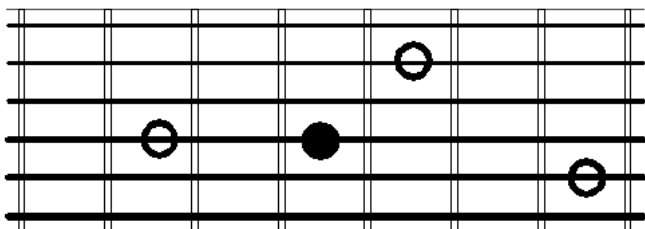
10 half-steps



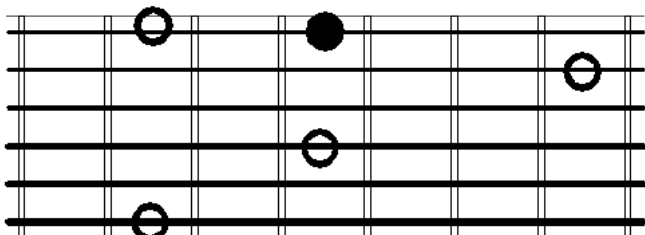
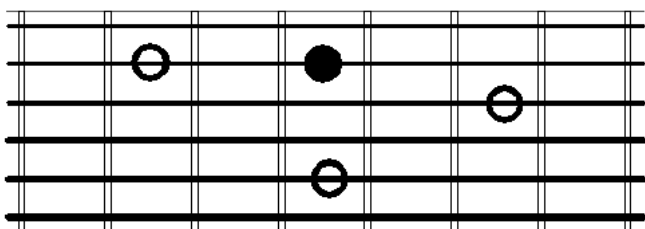
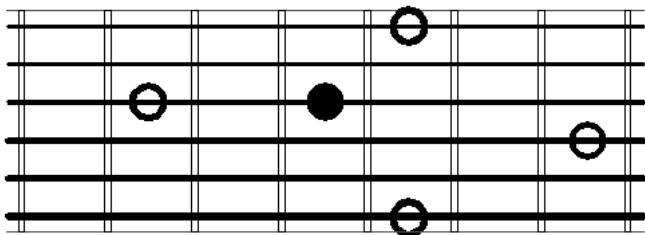
Adding 1 octave:

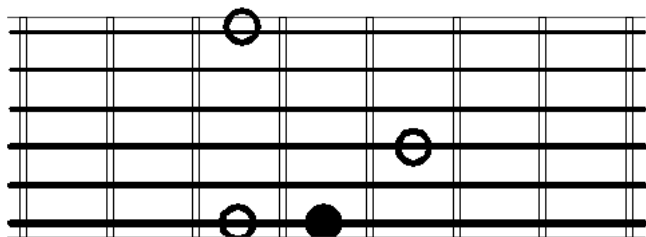
Minor Fourteenth

Enharmonic equivalent:



Augmented Sixth

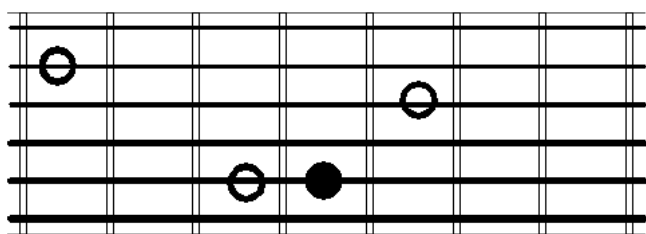




Major Seventh

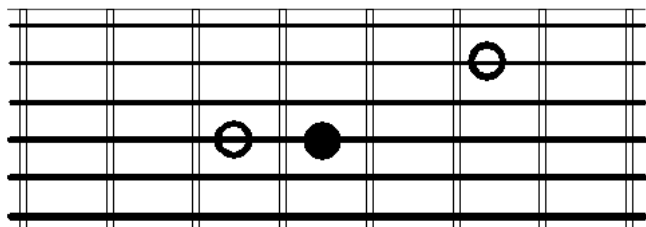
11 half-steps

Adding 1 octave:

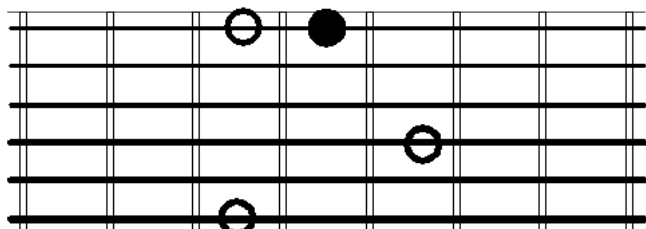
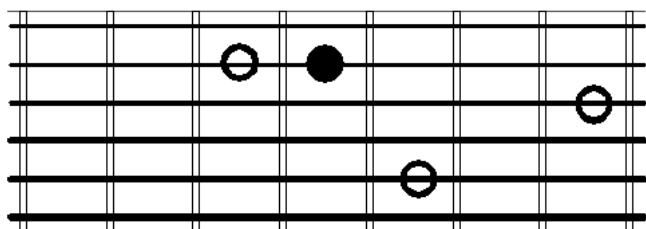
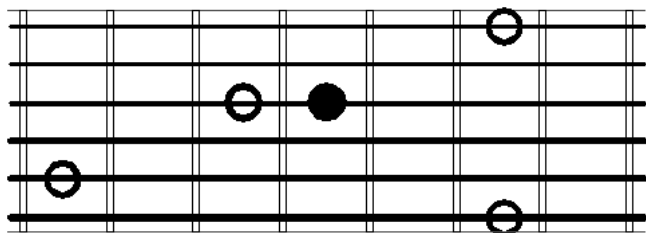


Major Fourteenth

Enharmonic equivalent:



Diminished Octave



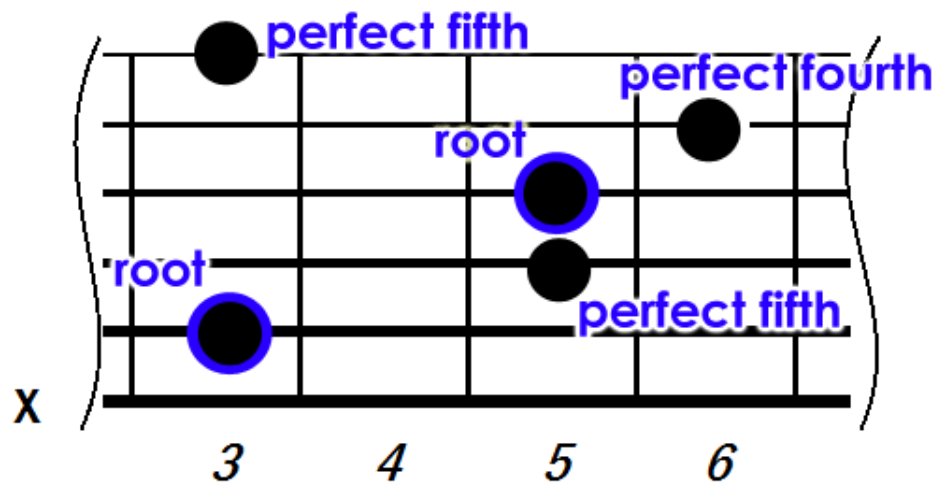
Chords Construction

Here below you find some example of chords built with the new types of intervals:

Csus4 chord

Name variations: **C suspended fourth, C4, C#3**

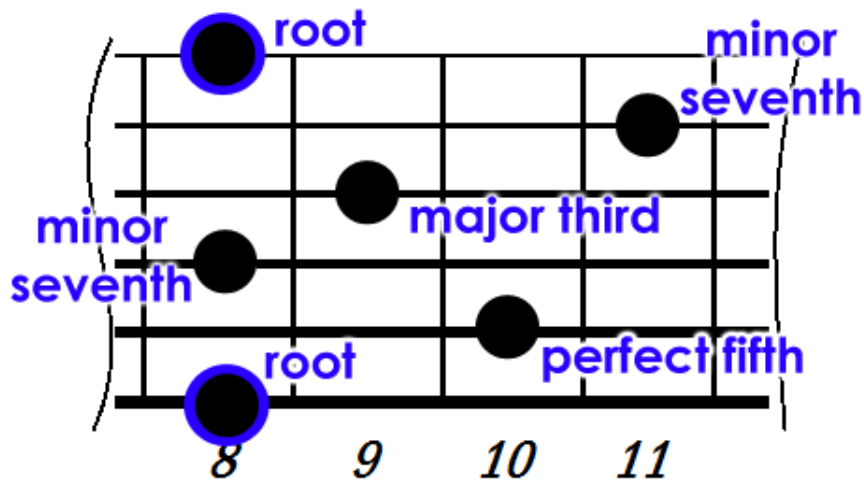
This chord is composed of the root, a perfect fourth and has no third (suspended), therefore is neither major nor minor.



C7 chord

Name variations: **C dominant seventh, Cdom7**

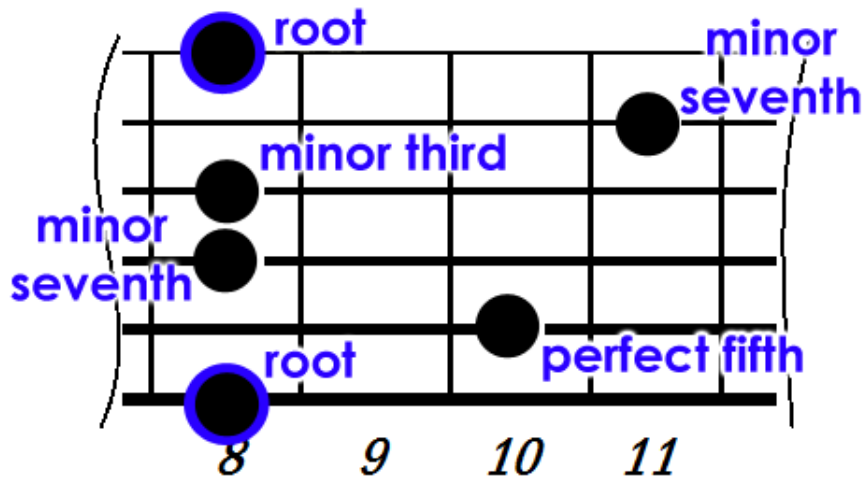
This chord is a major triad with a minor seventh.



Cmin7 chord

Name variations: **C minor seventh, Cm7, C-7**

This chord is a minor triad (root, minor third, perfect fifth) with a minor seventh.



Cmaj7 chord

Name variations: **C major seventh, CM7, CΔ7**

This chord is a major triad (root, major third, perfect fifth) with a major seventh.

